

| Grammar | Tenses |

I: PERSONS (FOUNDATION FOR TENSES)

Person	Meaning		Singular	Plural
First Person	Speaker	பேசுபவர்	I (நான்)	We (நாம்/நாங்கள்)
Second Person	Listener	கேட்பவர்	You (நீ)	You (நீங்கள்)
Third Person	Others	பிறர்	He, She, It (அவன், அவள், அது)	They (அவர்கள்/அவை)

II: THE 5 FORMS OF A VERB (V1 to V5)

- **V1 (Base):** write
- **V2 (Past):** wrote
- **V3 (Past Participle):** written (Used in Perfect Tenses)
- **V4 (Present Participle):** writing (Used in Continuous Tenses)
- **V5 (s/es):** writes (Used for 3rd Person Singular)

III: WHAT IS TENSE?

English: Tense shows the time of an action (past, present, future)

Tamil: Tense என்பது செயல் நடைபெறும் காலத்தை குறிக்கிறது

THE 12 TENSES

1. SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE (V1 / V5)

Meaning: Used for habits, facts, routines

Tamil: வழக்கமான செயல்கள், உண்மைகள்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. **Habit / Routine** (வழக்கமான செயல்)
I wake up at 6 am
2. **General Truth** (பொதுவான உண்மை)
Water boils at 100°C
3. **Permanent Situation** (நிலையான நிலை)
I live in Chennai
4. **Repeated Actions** (மீண்டும் நடைபெறும் செயல்)
She goes to school daily
5. **Timetable / Schedule** (நேர அட்டவணை நிகழ்வு)
The train leaves at 5 pm
6. **Instructions** (வழிமுறை)
Open the book

7. **Commentary** (நிகழ்வு விளக்கம்)

Dhoni hits a six

8. **Feelings / Thoughts** (கருத்து வெளிப்பாடு)

I think this is good

Third Person Singular (He/She/It) → Verb + s/es

Subject	Correct	Wrong
He	He plays	He play
She	She writes	She write

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. He ____ to school daily
A) go B) goes C) going D) gone
2. Water ____ at 100°C
A) boil B) boils C) boiling D) boiled
3. Choose correct sentence
A) He go to school B) He goes to school
C) He going to school D) He gone to school

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
He/She/It → s	She plays
Habit → Simple Present	I go daily
Think (opinion) → simple	I think

- **Secret Rule:** If the subject is **He, She, or It**, add **-s** or **-es** to the verb.
- **Key Words:** Always, usually, everyday, often, never, universal truths.

2. PRESENT CONTINUOUS TENSE (am/is/are + V4)

Meaning: Action happening now

Tamil: இப்போது நடைபெறும் செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. **Action happening now** (இப்போது நடைபெறும் செயல்)
She is reading
2. **Temporary action** (தற்காலிக செயல்)
I am staying in Madurai
3. **Changing situation** (மாறும் நிலை)
The climate is changing
4. **Planned future** (திட்டமிட்ட எதிர்காலம்)
I am going tomorrow
5. **Repeated annoying action** (தொந்தரவு செயல்)
He is always talking

6. **Current situation** (நடப்பு நிலை)
Children are playing
7. **Live commentary** (நேரடி விளக்கம்)
She is running fast
8. **Rule** (நிலைச் சொற்கள் விதி)
I know ✓
I am knowing ✗

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. She ____ playing now
A) is B) are C) am D) be
2. Identify tense
"They are watching TV"
A) Present simple B) Present continuous
C) Past D) Future
3. *Error correction*
I am knowing the answer
A) I know the answer B) I knowing the answer
C) I knew the answer D) No error

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
am/is/are + ing	She is playing
Now → continuous	He is reading now

Non-Action Verbs (The Trap): Words like **Love, Hate, Know, Believe, Understand** never take -ing in standard exams.

I am knowing the answer. (X)

I know the answer. (✓)

3. PRESENT PERFECT TENSE (has/have + V3)

Meaning: Past action with present result

Tamil: கடந்த செயல் → இப்போது தாக்கம்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Completed action (முடிந்த செயல்)
I have finished my work
2. Experience (அனுபவம்)
I have visited Ooty
3. Recent action (சமீப செயல்)
She has just left
4. Present result (தற்போதைய விளைவு)
He has broken his leg
5. Duration (கால அளவு)
I have lived here for 5 years

6. Repeated action (மீண்டும் நடந்த செயல்)
We have written many tests
7. Change over time (மாற்றம்)
Your English has improved
8. Rule (விதி): ✗ I have seen yesterday

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. She ____ completed her work
A) has B) have C) had D) is
2. Choose correct
A) I have seen him yesterday B) I saw him yesterday
C) I seeing him yesterday D) I seen him yesterday

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
has/have + V3	She has written
No past time specific words	Yesterday, 1999 ✗
since/for → perfect	for 5 years

4. PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Meaning: Action started in past and continues

Tamil: கடந்த காலத்தில் தொடங்கி இன்றும் தொடரும் செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Ongoing action (தொடரும் செயல்)
I have been studying
2. Duration (கால அளவு)
She has been working since morning
3. Visible result (விளைவு)
He is tired
4. Repeated action (மீண்டும் நடைபெறும் செயல்)
She has been calling

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. She ____ been working A) has B) have C) had D) is
2. Identify tense: "I have been reading"

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
have/has been + ing	She has been reading
since/for	since morning

5. SIMPLE PAST TENSE (V2)

Meaning: Completed past action

Tamil: கடந்த காலத்தில் முடிந்த செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Completed action ((முடிந்த செயல்)
I wrote the exam
2. Past habit (கடந்த வழக்கம்)
I played cricket
3. Story narration (கதை)
Once there lived a king
4. Series (தொடர்ச்சி)
He came, saw, won
5. Specific time (குறிப்பிட்ட நேரம்)
I met him yesterday

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. go → ____ A) goed B) went C) going D) gone
2. Identify tense: "She played chess"

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
V2 form	went
yesterday → past	yesterday

- **Key Signal Words:** Yesterday, last week, ago, in 1947.

6. PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE (was/were + V4)

Meaning: Action in progress in past

Tamil: கடந்த காலத்தில் நடந்து கொண்டிருந்த செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Ongoing past (நடந்து கொண்டிருந்த செயல்)
I was reading
2. Interrupted (இடைமறித்த செயல்)
I was reading when he came
3. Parallel action (இரண்டு செயல்கள்)
She was cooking while I was studying

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. They ____ playing
A) was B) were C) is D) be

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
was/were + ing	She was playing
while → continuous	while

- **The "Interrupt" Rule:** Used when a long action was interrupted by a short action.
 - *Formula:* **Past Continuous + when + Simple Past**
 - "I **was watching** TV when the bell **ran**"

7. PAST PERFECT TENSE (had + V3)

Meaning: Earlier past

Tamil: முன்னதாக முடிந்த செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Earlier action (முன் நடந்த செயல்)
I had finished before he came

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. He ____ left before I came
A) has B) had C) have D) is

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
had + V3	had gone
before → past perfect	before

- **The "First Past" Rule:** When two actions happened in the past, the **first one** is Past Perfect.
 - *Formula:* **Past Perfect + before + Simple Past**
 - "The train **had left** before I reached the station." (The train left first!)

8. PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Meaning: Duration before past

Tamil: கடந்த காலத்தில் எவ்வளவு நேரம் நடந்தது

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Duration (நேர அளவு)
I had been studying

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. He had been ____
A) run B) running C) ran D) runs

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
had been + ing	had been reading

9. SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE (will + V1)

Meaning: Future action

Tamil: எதிர்கால செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

- Prediction (ஊகம்)
It will rain
- Decision (முடிவு)
I will go
- Promise (வாக்குறுதி)
I will help

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. *Identify tense:* "He will come"

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
will + V1	will go

10. FUTURE CONTINUOUS

Meaning: Future ongoing

Tamil: எதிர்காலத்தில் நடந்து கொண்டிருக்கும் செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

- Ongoing future (நடந்து கொண்டிருக்கும்)
I will be travelling

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. She will be ____
A) study B) studying C) studied D) studies

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
will be + ing	will be reading

11. FUTURE PERFECT (will have + V3)

Meaning: Completed before future time

Tamil: எதிர்காலத்தில் முன் முடியும் செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Completion (முடிவு)

I will have finished

TNTET MCQ CHECKPOINT

1. Identify tense

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
will have + V3	will have done

- **The "Deadline" Tense:** An action that will be finished by a certain time.
- **Key Signal Word: "By..."**
- "I **will have completed** the syllabus **by** next month."

12. FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Meaning: Duration in future

Tamil: எதிர்காலத்தில் நீண்ட நேரம் நடைபெறும் செயல்

ALL USAGE SCENARIOS

1. Duration (நேரம்)

I will have been working

POINTS TO REMEMBER

Rule	Example
will have been + ing	will have been working

TNTET "Spot the Error" Practice

Sentence	Error	Correct Answer	Why?
He is having a car.	is having	He has a car.	Possession is not continuous.
It is raining since morning.	is raining	It has been raining .	'Since' requires Perfect Continuous.

I have finished it yesterday.	have finished	I finished it.	'Yesterday' is a past time marker.
Look! The bird flies .	flies	is flying	'Look!' implies action happening now.

COMPLETE TABLE OF 12 TENSES (MASTER REVISION)

● PRESENT TENSE

Tense	Structure	Example	Key Use	Tamil Meaning
Simple Present	S + V1 / V+s	She plays	Habit, fact	வழக்கமான செயல்
Present Continuous	S + am/is/are + V+ing	She is playing	Action now	இப்போது நடைபெறும் செயல்
Present Perfect	S + has/have + V3	She has played	Past → present result	கடந்த செயல் – தற்போதைய விளைவு
Present Perfect Continuous	S + has/have been + V+ing	She has been playing	Duration till now	தொடர்ந்து நடைபெறும் செயல்

● PAST TENSE

Tense	Structure	Example	Key Use	Tamil Meaning
Simple Past	S + V2	She played	Completed past	முடிந்த செயல்
Past Continuous	S + was/were + V+ing	She was playing	Ongoing past	நடந்துகொண்டிருந்த செயல்
Past Perfect	S + had + V3	She had played	Earlier past	முன்னதாக முடிந்த செயல்
Past Perfect Continuous	S + had been + V+ing	She had been playing	Duration before past	கடந்த காலத்தில் தொடர்ந்த செயல்

FUTURE TENSE

Tense	Structure	Example	Key Use	Tamil Meaning
Simple Future	S + will + V1	She will play	Future action	எதிர்கால செயல்
Future Continuous	S + will be + V+ing	She will be playing	Ongoing future	நடைபெற்று கொண்டிருக்கும் செயல்
Future Perfect	S + will have + V3	She will have played	Completed before future time	முன் முடிந்திருக்கும் செயல்
Future Perfect Continuous	S + will have been + V+ing	She will have been playing	Duration in future	தொடர்ந்து நடைபெறும் செயல்

SUPER MEMORY TABLE (VERY IMPORTANT FOR TNTET)

Type	Formula Shortcut
Simple	V1 / V2 / will + V1
Continuous	be + V+ing
Perfect	have + V3
Perfect Continuous	have been + V+ing

SIGNAL WORDS QUICK TABLE (EXAM HACK)

Clue Word	Tense
everyday, always	Simple Present
now, look, listen	Continuous
just, already, since, for	Perfect
yesterday, ago	Past
by (future time)	Future Perfect

QUICK IDENTIFICATION TRICKS

If you see...	Answer
Verb + s (he/she/it)	Simple Present
am/is/are + ing	Present Continuous

has/have + V3	Present Perfect
was/were + ing	Past Continuous
had + V3	Past Perfect
will + V1	Future
will have + V3	Future Perfect

FINAL ONE-LINE SUMMARY

👉 **Tense = Time + Verb Form**

👉 Present → now

👉 Past → completed

👉 Future → yet to happen

Free Online Test Link for this topic: <https://forms.gle/bTVN3Jj1WTfxyddP8>

Subscribe and enable Notification to our Official YouTube Channel - TNSed-Thanjavur for regular videos to prepare for TNTET :

<https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCy2e9cbpOCUKiO59LpIIwtg>

For Free TNTET Paper-01 & 02 Materials, Videos, Online Tests visit Our Official Website: www.tnclassroom.com
